

KI TONG

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

10+ years in professional practice as a Chartered Landscape Architect. Specialist in quantitative and qualitative research methods, statistical modelling, and user-centred design, with a portfolio spanning healthcare, environmental, and infrastructure projects. Published in high-impact journals including Age and Ageing (IF 9.5) and PLoS One, applying R, SPSS, and NVivo to analyse behavioural data, develop metrics, and extract actionable insights. Proficient in geospatial analysis, data visualisation, and computational tools, having delivered GIS, R, and AutoCAD training to over 100 academics and students. Experienced in leading interdisciplinary teams, facilitating participatory design workshops, and translating complex findings into evidence-based solutions—bridging the gap between research, design, and real-world impact.

ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

Centre for Data, Culture and Society | University of Edinburgh

Sep 2023 - Present

Teaching Fellow

Designed and delivered research methods training to over 100 academics and students, focusing on data analysis, geospatial visualisation, and computational tools including R, GIS, and AutoCAD. Developed and lectured a geospatial visualisation and analysis module using R, enabling students to transform raw data into legible outputs for inferences and further analyses. Provided one-to-one consultations to support survey design, data cleaning, and visual storytelling for research projects across disciplines. Achieved consistently high participant feedback (average 4.8/5), reflecting the accessibility and practical value of the training.

Creative Scotland

Jul 2023 - Jul 2025

Research Consultant

Advised on research workflows and database management for geolocating over 2,000 key creative production venues across Scotland. Conducted geocoding using automated APIs and performed data cleaning in R to ensure data accuracy and consistency. Applied non-parametric statistical analysis to examine relationships between building carbon readiness and typologies, including EPC ratings, to identify patterns in sustainability performance. Designed and developed interactive maps to visualise pilot findings, enabling stakeholders to explore results and identify trends. Provided robust, evidence-based insights that informed the progression of a subsequent project valued at over £500,000.

Edinburgh Climate Change Institute (ECCI) | University of Edinburgh

Jan 2023 - Sep 2023

Advanced Earth Fellow

Designed and facilitated four participatory workshops involving over 50 participants to explore user-centred solutions for reducing domestic energy consumption and enhancing energy infrastructure resilience. Applied structured activities and interactive dialogue methods to effectively capture user needs, behaviours, and pain points, resulting in the identification of critical knowledge gaps. Performed thematic analysis using NVivo to examine systematic barriers and facilitators related to domestic energy reduction, and determined the implications for projected energy consumption. Translated insights into actionable recommendations that directly informed a multi-national grant proposal valued at over £1 million, involving eight partner countries.

WP4 Advanced Care Research Centre | University of Edinburgh

Sep 2022 - Jun 2025

Research Assistant

Conducted advanced statistical analyses using hierarchical and non-parametric models in R and SPSS to examine relationships between health conditions, outdoor activities, and well-being in older adults. Presented these data-driven research findings at two international environmental research conferences. Authored two manuscripts for publication, with one accepted by a Q2-ranked journal (SJR).

Edinburgh College of the Arts | University of Edinburgh

Sep 2021 - Present

Supervisor | Guest Lecturer | Tutor

For MSc Landscape and Wellbeing and MA(Hons) Landscape Architecture

Supervised nine MSc Landscape and Wellbeing dissertations, with 75% of students achieving a Merit or higher; one student was awarded a fully funded PhD scholarship immediately upon graduation. Delivered lectures for three SCQF Level 11 courses, covering questionnaire design, walking interview methods, and data analysis. Provided academic support to an average of over 30 students per semester, tutoring in research design and statistical analysis using SPSS and R. Assessed coursework and provided comprehensive feedback aligned with marking rubrics to ensure fairness and consistency with learning outcomes. Designed and taught a six-hour undergraduate module on design skills, focusing on geospatial data visualisation using QGIS and advanced rendering with Adobe Suite. Average student satisfaction for MSc Landscape and Wellbeing at 4.5/5.0 or above (university average 3.0).

School of Health, Wellbeing & Social Care | Open University

Sep 2021 - Jun 2025

Research Assistant

Authored two articles, including one published in a Q1-ranked journal (JCR). Developed three systematic review protocols (SPIDER, PICO frameworks). Led coordination and project management of an international, multidisciplinary team (four countries, eight institutions).

Department of Psychology | The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Aug 2014 - Aug 2016

Teaching Assistant | Research Assistant

Planned and delivered tutorials for undergraduate psychology courses, supporting over 100 students per semester in research design, data collection, and analysis. Designed and conducted experiments incorporating biometric measures, facial coding, and quantitative emotional data to investigate behavioural responses. Conducted over 50 interviews with older adults to explore socioecological factors influencing physical activity, and collaborated with hospitals to analyse group-based interventions for adolescents with ASD. Applied hierarchical modelling in SPSS to evaluate intervention outcomes. Coordinated with academics, healthcare professionals, and community partners to deliver group-based interventions.

Centre for Learning Enhancement and Research | Hong Kong

Sep 2010 - Jul 2014

Project Coordinator

Led two government-funded research projects (combined value over HKD 200,000) investigating the design of learning activities and physical spaces in tertiary education. Applied qualitative methods, including photo-elicitation and go-along interviews, to gather user feedback from over 150 participants. Evaluated learning space effectiveness by analysing user needs, behavioural patterns, and environmental factors. Coordinated with academics, facilities managers, designers, and policy-makers to ensure recommendations were both evidence-based and operationally feasible. Developed annual tutoring manuals for 80–100 lecturers and teaching assistants to improve delivery of in-class activities, directly influencing the user experience of students and teaching staff.

LANDSCAPE WORK EXPERIENCE

AECOM United Kingdom

Aug 2025 - Present

Senior Landscape Architect

Delivered assessment reports independently for numerous large-scale energy and infrastructure projects across England and Scotland as part of comprehensive Environmental Impact Assessments (EIA). Provided expertise on s37 planning applications and developed key landscape mitigation strategies. Key clients included Scottish Power Energy Networks, Scottish and Southern Electric (SSE), and National Grid.

RAMBOLL United Kingdom

Feb 2022 - Aug 2025

Principal Landscape Architect

Delivered over eight landscape and visual assessments within two and a half years of employment across various projects—including Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS), transmission infrastructure, industrial developments, and Townscape and Visual Impact Assessments (TVIAs). This work included the production of verified photography and visualisations, ensuring accuracy and compliance with planning standards. Coordinated with multidisciplinary teams—including ecologists, engineers, visualisers, and GIS specialists—to successfully deliver landscape assessments, resolve design and technical issues, and meet planning requirements efficiently for projects such as West Fraser, BESS South Lanarkshire, and Microsoft.

The Urbanists United Kingdom**Apr 2021 - Feb 2022****Senior Landscape Architect**

Collaborated with urban designers to deliver public realm masterplanning for the £150 million Cardiff Arena development, integrating landscape-led design strategies into a complex urban regeneration project. Independently led the preparation and submission of planning applications for major mixed-use, residential, and educational developments within the masterplan area, contributing to timely approvals and positive stakeholder engagement. Developed comprehensive construction information packages for tender and independently administered construction phases, ensuring delivery aligned with the design intent, programme, and regulatory standards.

Macgregor Smith United Kingdom**Jun 2016 - Apr 2022****Landscape Architect**

Successfully secured a contract to review and update the landscape character of rural areas spanning over 700 sq km, covering 31 district character types and incorporating 160 sq km of ecological designations, woodlands, and stewardship areas. Enabled the award of three new projects within six months by introducing GIS tools to streamline bid preparation, reducing production time and improving submission accuracy. Coordinated two large-scale residential developments (each exceeding 100 ha) over a two-year period, achieving regulatory approval for six intermediate phases and ensuring compliance with planning frameworks. Independently prepared and submitted full planning application packages for the six approved intermediate phases, meeting all statutory requirements and deadlines. Led the design of spatial layout, construction detailing, and bespoke features (furnishings, signage, incidental play) for a 40 ha Suitable Alternative Natural Greenspace (SANG) at Buckler's Park, shortlisted for the Landscape Institute Award. The site buffers a designated Special Protection Area and safeguards over 20 ha of existing woodland, integrating conservation with public amenity.

Blue Vision Hong Kong**Sep 2011 - Aug 2014****Landscape Architect**

Developed comprehensive BIM models to support masterplanning, architectural, and interior design projects. Produced graphical visualisations and digital models using Revit and Lumion for international projects across five regions: Hong Kong, Macao, Shenzhen, Dubai, and London. Created structured teaching materials for a 90-hour BIM course delivered to professionals and students at vocational institutions.

PUBLICATIONS

Tong, K., Pearce, C., Kingston, A., Berry, K., & Ward Thompson, C. (2025). Older adults' outdoor activities and quality of life: a personal projects approach. *Journal of Aging and Environment*, 1-27.

Tong, K., Wainwright, J. E., Horne, J., Jones, K., Dadova, K., Alder, E., Leu, A., Birkett-Swan, L., & Vseteckova, J. (2025). Navigating dementia care: a systematic review of young and young adult carers' needs and support solutions. *Aging & Mental Health*, 1-14.

Tong, K., Thompson, C. W., Carin-Levy, G., Liddle, J., Morton, S., & Mead, G. E. (2025). Nature-based interventions for older adults: a systematic review of intervention types and methods, health effects and pathways. *Age and Ageing*, 54(4), afaf084.

Calafiore, A., & **Tong, K.** (2025). Does noise pollution influence modal choices? A random forest application. *PLoS One*, 20(6), e0325249.

Tong, K., Attenborough, K., Sharp, D., Taherzadeh, S., Deepak-Gopinath, M., & Vseteckova, J. (2024). Acceptability of remote monitoring in assisted living/smart homes in the United Kingdom and associated use of sounds and vibrations—a systematic review. *Applied Sciences*, 14(2), 843.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS**PhD (Candidate) Integrative Studies**

University of Edinburgh

MSc in Building Information Modelling

Oxford Brookes University

MSc in Arboriculture and Urban Forestry

University of Central Lancashire

MPhil in Psychology

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Master of Landscape Architecture

Edinburgh College of the Arts

Bachelor of Business Administration

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology